

# Breathing

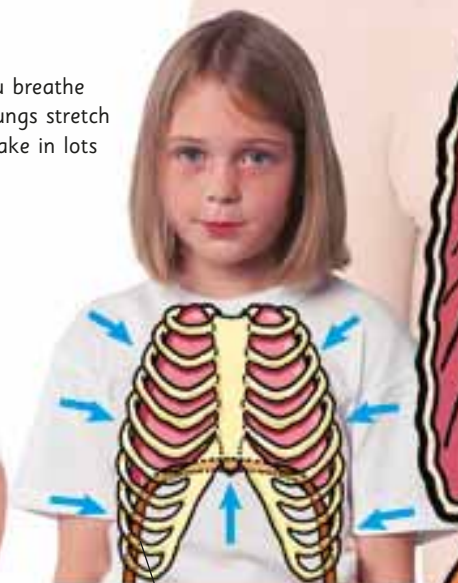
We have to breathe all the time in order to supply our bodies with oxygen and to get rid of carbon dioxide. We use our lungs to do this.

## Prepare the air

Before the air reaches your lungs it travels through your mouth and nose and then goes down your windpipe. It gets warm and damp on its journey.



When you breathe in, your lungs stretch out and take in lots of air.



### In and out

Your ribs and diaphragm help you to breathe. Your lungs fill with air when you raise your ribcage, then empty out when you lower it. A muscle called the diaphragm helps you do this.

When you breathe out your lungs squash down forcing all the air out.

The diaphragm is like a trampoline.

The muscle under your lungs is called the diaphragm. It moves up and down as you breathe.

